

WACŁAW Z SZAMOTUŁ

c. 1524 – c. 1560

Nunc scio vere

Introitus in festo SS. Apostolorum Petri et Pauli



Antiphon and Gloria Patri for four voices

CRITICAL EDITION

from the lost organ tablature of c. 1590 and the reconstruction by Mirosław Perz (1966)

edited by Mikołaj Derduń

First edition · 2026

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POLISH EARLY MUSIC 2. Wacław z Szamotuł, *Nunc scio vere*. First edition, 2026. Edited by Mikołaj Derduń.

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Source files, corrections and later editions: <https://github.com/mderdun/pol-ren/editions/nunc-scio-vere>.

Set in Junicode; music engraved with LilyPond and Gregorio.

THE WORK

NUNC SCIO VERE ('Now I know for certain') is the Introit for Saints Peter and Paul (29 June). Medieval Polish graduals also give it to Saint Peter's Chains (1 August). Waław set the antiphon and the *Gloria Patri*. The psalm verse between them was sung to its chant tone, and the antiphon was then repeated.

The setting survives in one source, an eight-leaf fragment of an organ tablature of about 1590. Aleksander Poliński found it, and it is called the 'Castle' tablature after the State Art Collections in the Royal Castle, Warsaw, where it was later kept. It passed to the National Library and was destroyed in 1944. The fragment was probably part of the Łowicz tablature, which contains a cycle of introits by Marcin Leopolita and others. *Nunc scio vere* stood on fols. 7v–8r, headed *In die Apostolorum Petri et Pauli. Nunc scio vere W. S.* ('On the day of the Apostles Peter and Paul. Now I know for certain. W. S.') The monogram is usually read as Waław's. Tomasz Czepiel doubts the attribution.

Waław studied in Poznań and Kraków. He became composer to Sigismund II Augustus in 1547 and later served Mikołaj Radziwiłł 'the Black'. Two other Latin motets by him survive, both printed in Nuremberg: *In te Domine speravi* (1554) and *Ego sum pastor bonus* (1564). A Kraków inventory of 1572, made after the death of Jurek Jasiuczyc, lists 'offitia Vaczlavove' ('Waław's offices'). Poles used *officium* for the introit, so these may have been settings like this one.

THE MUSIC

The introit chant (third mode) runs through the setting in equal values, lightly ornamented. It moves between voices. The Tenor has it for *Nunc scio vere* (bars 3–12) and the Cantus from *quia* to the end of the antiphon (13–56). In the *Gloria Patri* the Bassus recites the psalm tone on c (63–71). These entries are marked [c.f.]. The other voices treat each clause of text as a point of imitation. The antiphon ends on E, the final of the mode. The *Gloria Patri* ends on A, the last note of the psalm tone's termination.

THE RECONSTRUCTION

Mirosław Perz made a vocal version from photographs of the two pages and published it in 1966 (Ⓟ). He set it a minor third above the tablature (Ⓣ) and added his own underlay. His commentary records every reading of Ⓣ that he changed. This edition starts from Ⓟ, returns the music to the pitch of Ⓣ and weighs each of Perz's changes against Ⓣ. Most stand. At bars 6, 9, 30 and 81–83 Ⓣ's reading is restored. The critical notes list every decision, so any of them can be reversed.

SOURCES

- Ⓣ Organ tablature, c. 1590 ('Castle' or 'Small Warsaw' tablature; Poliński collection), fols. 7v–8r: *In die Apostolorum Petri et Pauli. Nunc scio vere W. S.* Text incipit only. Destroyed 1944. Glass-plate photographs of three pieces from the fragment, probably of 1928, are in the Institute of Musicology, Jagiellonian University (IMuzUJ 014–017).
- Ⓟ Mirosław Perz, vocal reconstruction from photographs of Ⓣ, in Hieronim Feicht (ed.), *Muzyka staropolska / Old Polish Music* (Kraków: PWM, 1966), pp. 61–65; commentary pp. 380–81. Up a minor third; values as in Ⓣ; editorial underlay. *Base text*, revised against Ⓣ.

EDITORIAL METHOD

Pitch and note values. Pitch is that of (T). At this pitch the antiphon ends on E with no signature, the normal position of the third mode, and the voices fit the ordinary low clefs (C₁, C₃, C₄, F₄). Cantus c'–e'', Altus f–a', Tenor d–e', Bassus E–a. A vocal original in this mode would have been notated this way, and nothing suggests the intabulator transposed it. (P)'s pitch would need three flats in the signature, which no source of the period uses. Written pitch was not sounding pitch, though (see Performance).

Note values are twice those of (T) and (P). German organ tablatures often halve the values of their vocal models. As Perz transcribes it, (T) moves in semiminims and fusae, with semifusae at cadences, values a vocal motet of about 1550 would hardly use. Doubled, the music moves in semibreves and minims under ♢, like Wacław's two printed motets. The bar is a breve, so bar numbers match (P). The mensuration sign is editorial: (T), a tablature, has none.

Score. Bar lines run between the staves only. Voice names and clefs are editorial. Each voice's range is shown at the head of its staff. Rests at entries follow (P), since a tablature notates rests only in part. The antiphon ends on semibreves under (P)'s corona (bar 56). The *Gloria Patri* ends on longs.

Accidentals. A tablature spells every pitch, so accidentals before notes come from (T). Accidentals above the staff are editorial, all of them suggested by Perz. Each sign applies only to the note it stands against. An accidental in brackets above a note is optional: the note as printed is the edition's reading, and the bracketed sign an alteration singers may make.

TEXT UNDERLAY

(T) gives only the text incipit. Every syllable below the notes is therefore editorial, placed by the method below.

1. *Chant.* Where a voice carries the cantus firmus, it takes the chant's syllables. Each syllable starts on the first note of its chant neume, and a chant melisma stays on one syllable, subject to the rules that follow.
2. *Wacław's practice.* His Kraków *Lamentationes* (1553) set most of the text one syllable to a note, repeated notes included. A melisma comes before the cadence on the stressed syllable of the last word, and the final syllable takes the cadence note (*mé–am, lú–cem, hó–minum, su–á–rum*). Short repeats are marked *ij*, longer ones written out. The Nuremberg prints of his motets agree at clause ends but place the words too loosely to settle more. Nine in ten clause-final words here follow the *Lamentationes*; the rest carry a short ornament or keep an imitative head-motif.
3. *The theorists.* These rules are kept without exception. A new syllable goes only on a minim or longer note (Lanfranco 1533; Zarlino 1558, IV.33). None goes on a dot. None goes on the semiminim after a dotted minim either: Zarlino forbids it, and although Lanfranco and Vicentino allow it, this setting never needs it. The first note after a rest and the last note of a phrase each take a syllable (Zarlino). No rest divides a word, and there is no elision (Vicentino 1555). A repeated note takes a new syllable unless it is a semiminim, one of Stoquerus's necessary rules (c. 1570, ch. 15).

Other rules are applied with the latitude Stoquerus allows the older generation of composers, the Netherlands whose idiom Wacław shares. After a run of semiminims the syllable usually changes on the second white note, not the first (Vicentino), but not always. Long or stressed syllables go to long notes (Zarlino). A clause is repeated to keep the voices together or for emphasis, and repeated whole (Stoquerus).

4. *Accent.* Stress follows the penultimate rule as Kraków taught it in Wacław's student years (Sebastian z Felsztyna 1518; Jerzy Liban c. 1539). Hence *Dóminus, ángelum, erípuit, Heródis, exspectatióne, Iudaéorum, princípío, saeculórum*.

5. *Imitation*. Each point of imitation takes its opening motif from a phrase of the chant, and the words of that phrase go with it. A motif keeps its words wherever it recurs. Perz used the same method for Leopolita's introits from this tablature (1967).

Repeated text is printed in italics, as editions print words supplied for a source's *ij*.

PERFORMANCE

At written pitch the setting suits an all-male chapel like Sigismund Augustus's, with boys or falsettists on the Cantus (c'–e'') and a low Bassus (E–a). The chapel paid boy singers (*pueri, adolescentes cantores*) alongside its men, and Wacław's *Lamentationes*, in clefs lower still, were written for low men's voices. Every voice lies two to five semitones lower than in Wacław's printed motets, the Cantus most of all. A minor third higher, as in (P), the four ranges match his printed ones almost exactly. That is the pitch for a mixed choir, and a sound choice for any choir, since written pitch fixed only the relations between the voices.

A minim pulse of about 60–72 suits the declamation. The organ may double the voices. The order is Antiphon, psalm verse (cantor, in chant), *Gloria Patri*, Antiphon. The Introit was often sung in alternation with the organ. Perz argued in 1967 that the *Gloria Patri* settings of Leopolita's introits in the same tablatures were organ versets, and that the organ could play the repeat of an introit while the choir said the words quietly. This edition texts the *Gloria Patri* because its Bassus recites the psalm tone syllable by syllable. An organ doxology or an organ repeat of the antiphon has as good a claim. Marcin Szelest has recorded the *Gloria Patri* from (T) as an organ piece (Accord, 2023).

Polish Latin suits the piece, with the sounds given in the series pronunciation guide. Stress follows the penultimate rule (rule 4 above). The guide's *tsi* for *ti* before a vowel keeps the *i* as a syllable, as the underlay does: ex-spe-cta-ti-o-ne.



TEXT AND TRANSLATION

Ant. Nunc scio vere,
 quia misit Dominus angelum suum:
 et eripuit me de manu Herodis,
 et de omni expectatione plebis Iudaeorum.
Ps. Domine, probasti me, et cognovisti me:
 tu cognovisti sessionem meam,
 et resurrectionem meam.
 Gloria Patri, et Filio, et Spiritui Sancto.
 Sicut erat in principio, et nunc, et semper,
 et in saecula saeculorum. Amen.

*Now I know for certain
 that the Lord has sent his angel
 and has rescued me from the hand of Herod
 and from all the expectation of the people of the Jews.
 Lord, you have searched me and known me;
 you know my sitting down
 and my rising up.
 Glory be to the Father, and to the Son,
 and to the Holy Spirit. As it was in the beginning,
 is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.*

Acts 12:11; Psalm 138 (139):1–2. The verse is given as in the *Graduale Romanum*. Medieval Polish graduals end it at *sessionem meam*; singers who prefer that reading apply the termination to *ses-si-ó-nem me-am*.

Nunc scio vere

Introitus in festo SS. Apostolorum Petri et Pauli

WACŁAW Z SZAMOTUŁ

Antiphona

CANTUS

ALTUS

TENOR

BASSUS

7

C.

A.

T.

B.

13

C.

A.

T.

B.

[c.f.]

Nunc sci - o ve - re, ve re,

Nunc sci - o ve re, ve - re, sci -

Nunc sci - o

Nunc sci - o ve - re, ve - re,

sci o ve - re,

o ve re, sci - o ve -

ve re, sci - o ve - re, qui -

sci - o ve - re, sci - o ve - re,

qui - a mi - sit Do - mi - nus an - ge -

re, qui - a mi - sit Do - mi - nus an - ge -

a mi - sit Do - mi - nus an - ge -

ve - re, qui - a mi - sit Do - mi - nus, Do - mi - nus an -

20

C. - lum su - - - um: et e - ri -

A. lum, an ge - lum su - - - um: et e - ri - pu -

T. - lum: su - - - um: et e - ri - pu -

B. ge - lum su - - - um: et e - ri - pu -

26

C. - pu it me de ma - nu

A. it me, et e - ri - pu - it me de ma -

T. it me, et e - ri - pu - it me de ma - nu He -

B. it me, et e - ri - pu - it me de ma - - nu

32

C. He - ro - dis,

A. - nu He - ro - dis, et de om - ni, et

T. ro - dis, He-ro - dis, et

B. He - ro - dis, He - ro - dis, et de om - ni, om -

39 (b)

C. et de om - ni ex - spe - cta - ti -

A. de om - ni ex - spe - cta - ti - o -

T. de om - ni ex - spe - cta - ti - o - ne

B. ni ex - spe - cta - ti - o - ne

45

C. - o - ne ple - bis, ple -

A. - ne ple - bis, ple - bis

T. ex - spe - cta - ti - o - ne ple - bis, ple -

B. - ple - bis, ple - bis Iu - dae - o -

51

C. - bis Iu - dae - o - rum.

A. Iu - dae - o - rum, Iu - dae - o - rum.

T. - bis Iu - dae - o - rum.

B. rum, Iu - dae - o - rum, Iu - dae - o - rum.

Psalmus. Tonus iii.

ψ. Dó - mi - ne pro - bá - sti me, et co - gno - ví - sti me: *

tu co - gno - ví - sti ses - si - ó - nem me - am, et re - sur - re - cti - ó - nem me - am.

Gloria Patri

57

CANTUS

Glo - ri - a Pa - tri, Pa - tri, et Fi - li -

ALTUS

Glo - ri - a Glo - ri - a Pa - tri,

TENOR

Glo - ri - a Pa - tri,

BASSUS

63

C.

o, et Spi - ri - tu - i San - cto, San -

A.

et Fi - li - o, et Spi - ri - tu - i

T.

et Fi - li - o, et Spi - ri - tu - i

B.

Glo - ri - a Pa - tri, et Fi - li - o, et

68

C.

- cto. Si - cut e - rat in prin - ci - pi - o, et

A.

San - cto, San - cto. Si - cut e - rat si - cut e -

T.

San - cto. Si - cut e - rat in prin - ci - pi -

B.

Spi - ri - tu - i San - cto. Si - cut e - rat

73

C. nunc, et sem - per, et in

A. rat in prin - ci - pi - o, et nunc, et sem -

T. o, et nunc, et sem - per, et in

B. in prin - ci - pi - o, et nunc, et sem - per, et

78

C. sae - cu - la sae - cu - lo - rum, sae - cu -

A. per, et in sae - cu - la sae - cu - lo - rum,

T. sae - cu - la sae - cu - lo - rum, sae - cu -

B. in sae - cu - la sae - cu - lo - rum, sae - cu - lo - rum, sae -

83

C. lo - rum. A - men, A - men.

A. sae - cu - la sae - cu - lo - rum. A - men, A - men.

T. la sae - cu - lo - rum. A - men, a - men.

B. cu - lo - rum. A - men, A - men, A - men.

Repetitur antiphona Nunc scio vere.



CRITICAL NOTES

READINGS OF (T) ALTERED IN (P)

References are to bar, voice and note; tied continuations are not counted. Pitches are at the pitch of this edition (c' = middle C), and note values are those of this edition, twice those of (T) and (P). Each note gives (T)'s reading, Perz's change and his reason, then this edition's decision in small capitals.

Perz's changes fall into three groups. Some cure a fault of counterpoint, such as parallel octaves, a mishandled dissonance or an inner voice given to the wrong part. These are **ACCEPTED**, because restoring (T) brings the fault back. Others remove a figure Perz thought instrumental. He judged it at the halved values of the tablature. At this edition's values the figures are ordinary vocal ornaments, so (T) is **RESTORED** unless it creates a fault. The last group joins repeated notes 'for the underlay'. (T) is restored where its repeated notes can carry syllables, as Stoquerus requires, and (P) stands where they cannot.

BAR	VOICE	NOTE
6	C	(T): e' tied from bar 5, e' (minims), f' d' (semiminims), e' (minim). (P): tied breve e' and breve rest, the figure being instrumental. At doubled values it is a common cadential ornament, and makes no fault. T RESTORED (<i>ve-re</i> repeated).
9	T	(T): in the second half, minim c' and semibreve c' tied into bar 10. (P): dotted semibreve, for the underlay. The repeated c' takes -o. T RESTORED .
20	A	(T): in the second half, minim f' and semibreve f' tied into bar 21. (P): dotted semibreve, for the underlay. (T) would give five repeated f' to the four syllables of <i>-lum an-ge-lum</i> . P ACCEPTED .
25	A, T	(T): A c', T g. (P) exchanges them, to avoid octaves and fifths with B. (T) gives octaves A-B twice and fifths T-B. P ACCEPTED .
26	A	(T): e' in place of the rest. Omitted in (P) for octaves with B. The octave is approached, not consecutive; but the rest lets the Altus breathe before its entry at <i>et eripuit</i> , and the e' is probably the organist's filling. P ACCEPTED .
30	A	(T): first note e'. (P): c', for the cadence the text creates. (T)'s e' supplies the only third of the C chord, which otherwise stands bare for a semibreve. T RESTORED .
31	A, T	(T): A c', T a. (P) exchanges them, restoring the tenor's line. P ACCEPTED .
34	A	(T): second note a. (P): b, for the cadence. The cadence to C has the 4-3 suspension in the Cantus, and b is its leading note. P ACCEPTED .
35-37	C	(T): two separate breves f'. (P) ties them, for the underlay. The second f' falls after the clause has ended, and no syllable is left for it. P ACCEPTED .
37	A	(T): the first two notes are one dotted semibreve d'. (P) divides it (semibreve, minim) to keep the imitation exact. P ACCEPTED (rule 5).
49-50	C	(T): minims g' e' in place of the tied semibreve g'. (P): g', for octaves with T. The octaves are real. P ACCEPTED .
49	B	(T): second note without rhythm sign; read as a minim.
52	C	(T): in the second half, semiminims d' c' d' e'. (P): dotted minim d', semiminim e' (instrumental figure; fifths with T). The figure is vocal at these values, but the fifths are real (C-T, bar 52). P ACCEPTED .
53	T	(T): first note f. (P): a, for octaves with C. The octaves are real. P ACCEPTED .
64	T	(T): third note d. (P): f, calling d an error. d would be a dissonant semiminim left by leap. P ACCEPTED .
71	A, T	(T): A c', T a. (P) exchanges them (imitation in A; octaves between T and B). The octaves are real. P ACCEPTED .

BAR	VOICE	NOTE
76–77	A	(T): one breve e' in each bar. (P): two semibreves each, for the underlay. The split gives <i>et nunc, et semper</i> in the declamation the other voices have. P ACCEPTED.
81	T	(T): third note b. (P): g, for the cadence. (T)'s b sounds the resolution against the Cantus's suspended c''. P ACCEPTED.
81–83	C	(T): minims c'' a' b' g' f' a', semibreves b' c'', minims c'' a'. (P): dotted semibreve c'', minim b', semibreves a' b', dotted semibreve c''; (P) calls the sequence instrumental. At these values it is a vocal sequence in minims, consonant throughout, without parallels. T RESTORED (<i>saeculorum</i> twice).
86	C	(T): two minims in place of the semibreve a'. (P) joins them, for the underlay. (T) would put the final syllable before the cadence. P ACCEPTED.
86	B	(T): second note d. (P): f, for octaves with A. The octaves are real. P ACCEPTED.

OTHER NOTES

BAR	VOICE	NOTE
15–16	C, T	Parallel fifths (b' e' to a' d', bar 16), left as in (T), following (P).
44	C	b' as in (T), a tritone above the bass F on the third minim; (P) does not alter it. bb', as in bar 45, is printed in brackets as an option.
44	B	The flat is (P)'s; (T) has B, against bb in the Tenor a minim later.
54	A, T	Parallel fifths on the first minim, as in (P).
56	A	e' (small note) is (P)'s addition, in square brackets in (P); (T) presumably continued c' from bar 55. (P)'s e' makes fifths with B (a–e', E–b); the tied c' does not, and is a fair alternative.
57–62	B, T	Bassus rests for six bars, Tenor for three; the <i>Gloria Patri</i> opens in two voices, as in (T).
88	A	c# (major final chord) is in (T); at bar 87 the sharp is (P)'s.

UNDERLAY

BAR	VOICE	NOTE
3–12	T	Cantus firmus. <i>Nunc</i> covers the chant's opening neume (f–d–g–f–e), <i>sci-o</i> its g and a; <i>-re</i> falls on the cadence note c' of bar 9, and the clause is repeated.
13–56	C	Cantus firmus. Syllables follow the chant, e.g. <i>om-</i> on g'–a' and <i>-ni</i> on d' (bars 41–42), and three syllables of <i>expectatione</i> on the repeated g' of bars 42–43. Where the chant and rule 3 conflict, the rule decides (<i>-mi-</i> of <i>Dominus</i> , bar 16).
26–29	C	The chant's melisma on <i>eripuit</i> falls on <i>-it</i> , not <i>-pu-</i> ; the Cantus follows it, with <i>-it</i> on the c'' of bar 27. Elsewhere, where a free voice had a melisma of more than four semibreves, the clause is repeated instead, as in Waclaw's prints (e.g. T, <i>expectatione</i> , bars 44–48; B, <i>eripuit me</i> , bars 25–30).
44–45	C	The stressed <i>-o-</i> of <i>expectatione</i> takes the semibreve a'; the chant's c'' at bar 44 carries <i>-ti-</i> .
50–56	ALL	The stressed <i>-o-</i> of <i>Iudaeorum</i> falls on a strong minim or a high note in every voice (e.g. C, the semibreve a' at bar 53).
63–71	B	The Bassus recites the psalm tone on c; its mediant shape (d c c, c–a, c) carries <i>-ri-tu-i San-cto</i> syllabically.

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